Lab Meeting, Journal Club and Mentoring

Adaeze Okafor · August 2026 (Fall 2026 rota added 24 August)

Lab meeting

When and where: every Thursday, 10:00–11:30, Keller 402 (the fourth-floor seminar room). Lab meeting moved from Tuesday afternoons to Thursday mornings in Fall 2025. Coffee is provided on the first Thursday of each month.

Format. Each meeting starts with about 10 minutes of lab business (announcements from Marisol and Tomasz, equipment news, the week's chores). Then the meeting alternates week by week between:

- **Research updates:** two speakers, about 30 minutes each including discussion. Show data, including the experiments that did not work. Unfinished work is welcome; this is where we fix problems early.
- **Journal club:** one presenter and one paper, 30–40 minutes. Post the paper in #journal-club by the Monday before. **Everyone reads the paper.**

Everyone attends, including undergraduates and rotation students. If you cannot come, tell me beforehand.

Rotation students give a 15-minute rotation talk at the last lab meeting of their rotation.

Fall 2026 schedule

Date	Type	Presenters
24 Sep	Research updates	Tomasz Brenner; Mei-Ling Zhou
1 Oct	Journal club	Rafael Castaño
8 Oct	Research updates	Hannah Lindqvist; Daniel Osei
15 Oct	Journal club	Aisha Bello
22 Oct	Research updates	Rafael Castaño; Lucas Ferreira
29 Oct	Journal club	Priya Raghunathan
5 Nov	Research updates	Aisha Bello; Priya Raghunathan
12 Nov	Journal club	Jordan Pike and Sofia Marchetti (joint)
19 Nov	Research updates	Ethan Park (rotation talk, 15 min); Mei-Ling Zhou
26 Nov	No meeting (Thanksgiving)	
3 Dec	Journal club	Mei-Ling Zhou
10 Dec	Research updates	Hannah Lindqvist; Daniel Osei
17 Dec	Journal club	Lucas Ferreira (end-of-term "papers we loved" session)

Swaps are fine: agree them with the other person and post in #journal-club.

Subgroup meetings

Protein subgroup, Mondays 14:00; Cell biology subgroup, Wednesdays 11:00. Both are in 418A. They are informal: bring a gel, a plot or a problem.

Mentoring and 1:1s

- **Graduate students and postdocs:** a 30-minute 1:1 with me every two weeks, at a standing time that Marisol schedules. Keep a running agenda in a shared document and add to it before each meeting.
- **Undergraduates:** a 20-minute 1:1 with me each month, plus a weekly meeting with your day-to-day mentor.
- **Rotation students:** 30 minutes with me in the first week, the fifth week and the final week, plus a short daily check-in with your rotation mentor.
- **Individual Development Plans:** graduate students and postdocs update their IDP every September, and we discuss it in a dedicated 1:1.
- **Day-to-day mentors, Fall 2026:** Ethan Park (rotation) with Hannah Lindqvist; Jordan Pike with Priya Raghunathan; Sofia Marchetti with Mei-Ling Zhou.

Authorship

- We discuss authorship at the *start* of every project, record what we agreed in the project document, and revisit it before submission. Contributions are described with the CRediT taxonomy.
- To be an author you must have made a substantial contribution to the conception or design of the work, or to acquiring or analysing its data; have helped draft or revise the paper; have approved the final version; and accept accountability for the work.
- The first author led the project and wrote the first draft. Co-first authorship is possible when that reflects the work. By default I am last and corresponding author.
- Undergraduates and rotation students are authors when their data appear in the paper and they meet the criteria above. Otherwise they are thanked by name in the acknowledgements. Technical help without an intellectual contribution is acknowledged, not given authorship.
- If you disagree about authorship, raise it early with me. If it cannot be resolved, the Westbrook Ombuds Office can help.

Conferences

The lab pays for one conference a year for graduate students (from year 2) and postdocs who are presenting a poster or a talk. Get my approval before you register. Undergraduates presenting lab work can apply for a Westbrook undergraduate research travel grant, and the lab adds up to $500. Book through Westbrook Travel and keep every receipt; Marisol handles reimbursements.